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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Title

1.1.1.1 The title of the Project is “Northern Metropolis Highway – San Tin Section” (hereafter referred to as the Project).

1.1.1.2 The Project is one of the four sections of the Northern Metropolis Highway (NMH), with the other three being the Tin Shui Wai Section, Kwu Tung Section and New Territories North (NTN) New Town Section. The NMH has an overall length of approximately 24 km.

1.2 Project Background

1.2.1.1 In December 2020, the Transport Department (TD) commissioned a consultancy study titled “Strategic Study on Major Roads beyond 2030 – Feasibility Study” (SSMR FS) under Agreement No. CE 7/2018 (TT). The SSMR FS examined the future configuration of Hong Kong’s major road infrastructure to ensure that the planning of major transport infrastructure will drive or even reserve capacity to meet Hong Kong's long-term development needs, including those proposed in the Northern Metropolis Development Strategy.

1.2.1.2 The 2022 Policy Address mentioned that three major road projects recommended under the Strategy Study on Major Roads beyond 2030 (SSMR2030+) would be taken forward to create a highly interconnected and accessible road network, significantly driving and supporting Hong Kong's future development. NMH is one of the three major road projects.

1.2.1.3 The 2023 Policy Address announced an extension of the NMH proposal to the east, connecting it to the Sha Tau Kok Road Interchange.

1.2.1.4 The NMH aims to establish a new strategic route improving east-west connectivity within the Northern Metropolis and reduce potential traffic congestion on Yuen Long Highway, San Tin Highway, and Fanling Highway.

1.2.1.5 The NMH is being taken forward following the principle of “Holistic Planning and Phased Implementation”. The investigation study for the entire NMH will be completed first, followed by detailed design and construction of individual sections to cater for the development needs and suit the allocation of public resources. The San Tin Section is tentatively ready for tendering in Year 2027. Subject to the further planning and the actual implementation of the Project, advance works and the associated study would tentatively commence in the same year or Year 2028 with target commissioning of the Project in or before 2036.

1.2.1.6 The NMH will take into account the transport infrastructure projects in the pipeline, including the capacity of roads and railways, overall cost-effectiveness and allocation of public resources, etc., in formulating a more concrete implementation programme, with a view to completing the remaining sections of the NMH in phases in about 3 to 4 years after the commissioning of the San Tin Section.

1.2.1.7 Being a part of the Northern Metropolis Highway, the Project comprises mainly a dual three-lane carriageway in the form of at-grade road, tunnel and viaduct, starts from the interchange of Yuen Long Highway / Tsing Long Highway on the west and

connects to Fanling Highway (Pak Shek Au Section), with associated interchanges and ancillary facilities.

1.2.1.8 AECOM Asia Company Limited and AtkinsRealis Asia Limited Joint Venture has been commissioned by the Highways Department to undertake Agreement No. CE 4/2024 (HY) – "Northern Metropolis Highway – Investigation", which commenced in March 2025. During the investigation, the Project has incorporated environmental benefit elements and integrated ecological-friendly design measures. For details, please refer to **Section 2.4**.

1.3 Designated Projects under Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance

1.3.1.1 The Project comprises various Designated Projects (DPs) in Part I, Schedule 2 of the EIAO as described in **Table 1.1**. and illustrated in **Figure 1.1** and **Figure 1.2**. Details of the scope of the Project are presented in **Section 2**.

Table 1.1 Schedule 2 Designated Projects in this Project

Schedule 2 Designated Project		Designated Project Element under this Project
Item A.1	A carriageway for motor vehicles that is an expressway, trunk road, primary distributor road or district distributor road	Construction and operation of trunk road with associated primary distributor road and district distributor road at interchanges
Item A.7	A road tunnel or railway tunnel more than 800 m in length between portals	Construction and operation of tunnels including one with a length of around 2.0km between portals
Item I.1	A drainage channel or river training and diversion works located less than 300 m from the nearest boundary of an existing or planned conservation area	Potential temporary diversion during construction of Interchange I/C-02 foundation in Kam Tin River, site formation and road construction near Ngau Tam Mei and Hadden Hill, which locate less than 300m from the nearest boundary of an existing conservation area
Item K.10	A depot for the storage of, or a manufacturing plant for the manufacture of, explosives (as defined by section 2 of the Dangerous Goods Ordinance (Cap. 295))	Temporary explosive magazine site at Tai Shu Ha (Yuen Long) during construction phase.
Item Q.1	All projects involving earthworks, dredging works and other building works partly or wholly in an existing or gazetted proposed country park or special area, a conservation area, an existing or gazetted proposed marine park or marine reserve, a site of cultural heritage, and a site of special scientific interest	Earthworks (e.g. at-grade road work, retaining wall construction, slope works, viaduct foundation construction, etc.), and building works partly or wholly in existing "Conservation Area" zone gazetted under Nam Sang Wai OZP no. S/YL-NSW/11 , Kam Tin North OZP no. S/YL-KTN/11, Ngau Tam Mei OZP no. S/YL-NTM/15 and San Tin Technopole OZP no. S/STT/2

1.3.1.2 A Project Profile (PP) (No. PP-683/2025) for the Project based on the 8.5-kilometer-long alignment in the earlier stage of the Study was submitted to the Environmental Protection Department (EPD) on 22 April 2025 for the application for an EIA Study Brief under Section 5(1)(a) of the Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance (EIAO). An EIA Study Brief No. ESB-373/2025 was subsequently issued on 5 June 2025.

1.3.1.3 Subsequent to the issue of the Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) Study Brief (No. ESB-373/2025), some changes were made to the project boundary, layout and design to facilitate the project development. In accordance with Clause 6.2 of the EIA Study Brief, confirmation had been sought from the Director of Environmental Protection in writing to confirm that the scope of issues covered by the EIA Study Brief (No. ESB-373/2025) can still cover the key changes, and the additional issues, if any, that the EIA report must address. Having reviewed the proposed changes, EPD confirmed that the EIA Study Brief is still valid.

1.4 Purpose of the EIA Study

1.4.1.1 The purpose of this EIA study as stated in the EIA Study Brief (No. ESB-373/2025) is to provide information on the nature and extent of environmental impacts arising from the construction and operation stages of the Project and associated activities that will take place concurrently. This information will contribute to decisions by the Director of Environmental Protection on:

(i) the overall acceptability of any adverse environmental consequences that are likely to arise as a result of the Project;

(ii) the conditions and requirements for the detailed design, construction and operation of the Project to mitigate against adverse environmental consequences wherever practicable; and

(iii) the acceptability of residual impacts after the proposed mitigation measures are implemented.

1.5 Objective of the EIA Study

1.5.1.1 The objectives of the EIA study as stated in the EIA Study Brief (No. ESB-373/2025) are as follows:

(i) to describe the Project and associated works together with the requirements and environmental benefits for carrying out the Project;

(ii) to identify and describe the elements of the community and environment likely to be affected by the Project and/or likely to cause adverse impacts to the Project, including both the natural and man-made environment and the associated environmental constraints;

(iii) to identify and quantify emission sources and determine the significance of impacts on sensitive receivers and potential affected uses, and to propose measures to mitigate these impacts;

(iv) to identify and evaluate any potential impacts from point and non-point pollution sources on the identified water systems and sensitive receivers and to propose measures to mitigate these impacts;

(v) to identify and quantify potential waste management requirements and to propose measures to mitigate these impacts;

(vi) to identify and quantify contaminated land within the Project area, and to propose measures to avoid disposal in the first instance;

(vii) to identify, evaluate and address any potential ecological impacts arising from the Project and to propose measures to mitigate these impacts;

(viii) to identify and quantify the fisheries impacts and to propose measures to mitigate these impacts;

(ix) to identify any potential landscape and visual impacts and to propose measures to mitigate these impacts;

(x) to identify any negative impacts on cultural heritage and to propose measures to mitigate these impacts;

(xi) to identify potential hazard to life impacts and to propose mitigation measures to mitigate these impacts;

(xii) to propose the provision of infrastructure or mitigation measures so as to minimize pollution, environmental disturbance and nuisance during the construction and operation stages of the Project;

(xiii) to investigate the feasibility, practicability, effectiveness and implications of the proposed mitigation measures;

(xiv) to identify, predict and evaluate the residual environmental impacts (i.e. after practicable mitigation) and the cumulative effects expected to arise during the construction and operation phases of the Project in relation to the sensitive receivers and potential affected uses;

(xv) to identify, assess and specify methods, measures and standards, to be included in the detailed design, construction and operation of the Project which are necessary to mitigate these residual environmental impacts and cumulative effects and reduce them to acceptable levels;

(xvi) to investigate the extent of the secondary environmental impacts that may arise from the proposed mitigation measures and to identify constraints associated with the mitigation measures recommended in the EIA study, as well as the provision of any necessary modification; and

(xvii) to design and specify the environmental monitoring and audit requirements.

1.6 Structure of this Report

1.6.1.1 The background of the Project, purpose and objectives of this Report are introduced in this section. A description of the Project is provided in **Section 2**. **Sections 3** to **12** detail the assessment of each key environmental issue covering relevant

legislation, assessment criteria, baseline environmental conditions, methodology and assessment findings.

1.6.1.2 **Sections 3** to **12** are outlined below:

- **Section 3 –** Air Quality;
- **Section 4 –** Noise;
- **Section 5 –** Water Quality;
- **Section 6 –** Waste Management Implications;
- **Section 7 –** Land Contamination;
- **Section 8 –** Ecology;
- **Section 9 –** Fisheries;
- **Section 10 –** Landscape and Visual Impact;
- **Section 11 –**Cultural Heritage; and
- **Section 12 –** Hazard to Life.

1.6.1.3 An outline of the requirements for Environmental Monitoring and Audit (EM&A) programme is presented in **Section 13**. The EM&A programme is presented in details in a separate EM&A Manual. A summary of environmental outcomes is provided in **Section 14** and conclusion of the whole EIA study is presented in **Section 15**.

1.6.1.4 An Executive Summary has been prepared as a separate document in both Chinese and English, which contains summaries of the key findings, recommendations and conclusions of the EIA Report.